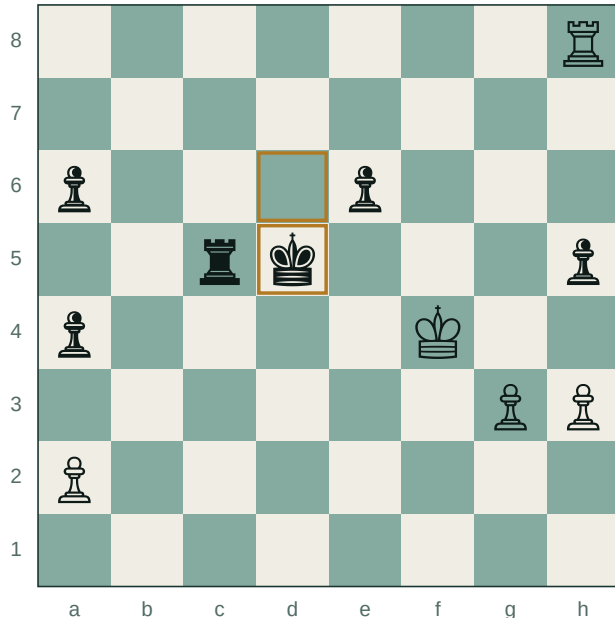


Rook-ending tactics: White, move 40

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 39...Kd5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40. Rxh5+ e5+ 41. Rxe5+

40.Rxh5+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on h5. Recorded reply: **40...e5+**.

41.Rxe5+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on d5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.